



Longer robes As in the Middle Ages, older men tended to wear longer robes and outer garments. This Germanic man of about 1580 wears a short robe and drooping breeches that would have looked dated to fashionable contemporaries.



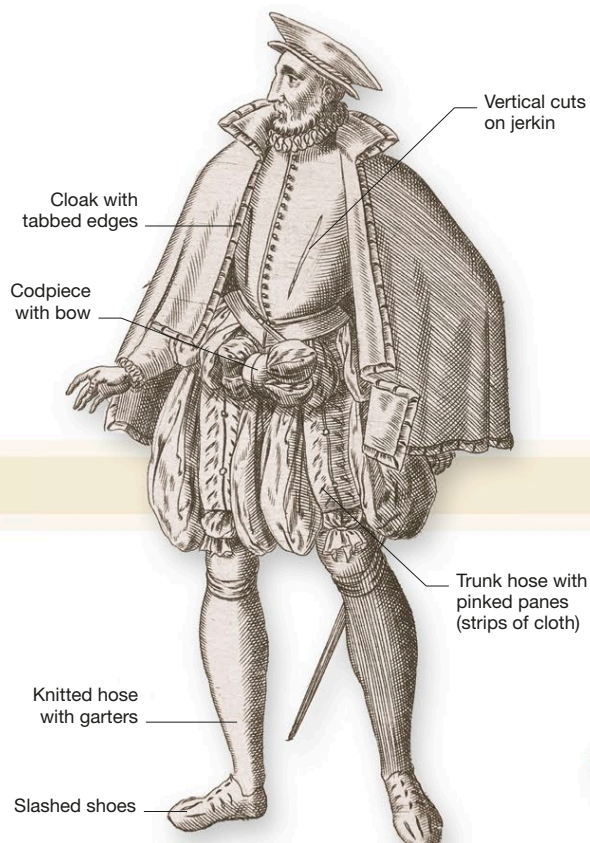
Complete ensemble In this painting from the mid-1560s August, Elector of Saxony, has wide embroidered gold bands delineating the edges of his cloak, skirted jerkin, and panned breeches, which emphasize the shapes of his Lutheran clothing. Like Catholic rulers, he favours black.



Statesman in red In this 1560 painting, Italian Gian Gerolamo Grumelli wears red from head to foot, though each element is subtly different. A variety of textiles – satin, velvet, leather – and clever surface embellishment give a distinct look to each part of his body.



Outrageous hose In France breeches were nearly spherical. A 1562 English statute legislated against “monstrous and outrageous greatness of hose” and fined those who wore them too large.



Cutting on every surface This drawing of a German man from the 1570s combines most types of decoratively cut cloth in his ensemble. Slashing was an effective way of adding surface detail and was cheaper than embroidery or braid.